



The Sherwin-Williams Company (NYSE: SHW) Equity Research Report

Little Investment Bankers of Rutgers

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Company Description

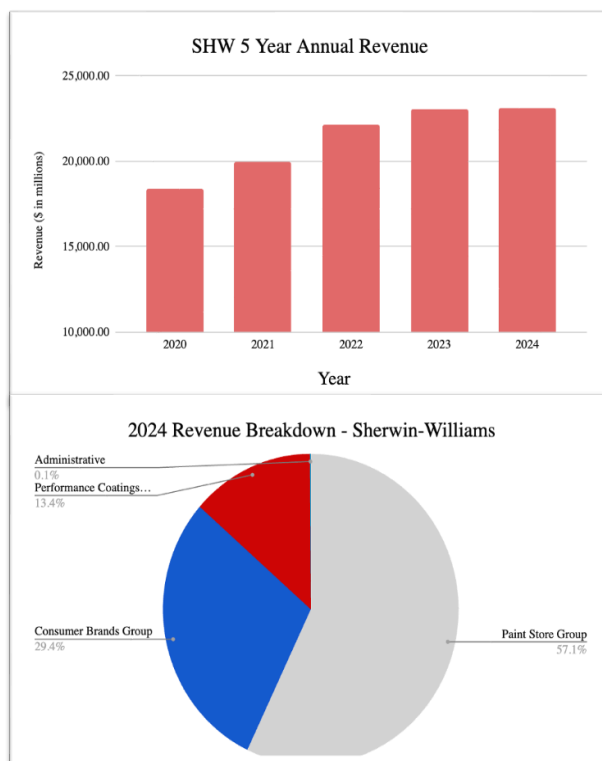
The Sherwin-Williams (SHW) company is a global paint company that takes part in the manufacturing, distribution, and direct sales of color paint, paint brushes, coatings, stains, and finishes, and any other color solutions. Sherwin-Williams was founded in 1866 and is headquartered in Cleveland, Ohio. The company is registered with the NYSE as it continues to serve professional and consumer markets. The company operates in three different segments:

- 1) **Paint Stores Group:** Provides direct paint and coating suppliers to a network of businesses.
- 2) **Performance Coatings Group:** Provides coatings for different sectors of business worldwide. Sectors include industrial, automotive, and aerospace industries.
- 3) **Consumer Brands Group:** Provides paint, stains, and coatings through retail partners and distributors.
- 4) **Administrative Group:** A negligible amount of revenue stream primarily from real-estate sales.

With operations in over 120 countries, over 5000 stores, and over 130 manufacturing and distributing facilities, the company is the leading player in the paint industry. The company owns 12 brands that focus mainly on color and home improvement products.

In 2024, SHW made \$23,098.5 Billion and has been steadily growing for the last few years. Their Compounded Annual Revenue Growth from 2020-2024 is about 5.2%. They have a current market cap of about \$81.01 Billion.

Additionally, as seen below, their largest revenue stream is the Paint Stores Group. In 2024, they accounted for about 57.1% of all annual revenue, followed by the Consumer Brands Group (29.4%), the Performance Coatings Group (13.4%) and the Administrative Group (0.1%).





Industry Analysis

Sherwin-Williams, created in the mid-19th century, is a well-known company in the paint and coatings industry. According to Yahoo! Finance, the global paint and coatings industry is steadily growing. The industry's market size was about 211.28 billion in 2024. By 2032, the forecasted market size is approximately 280.19 billion, rising at a CAGR of 5.2%. Although Sherwin-Williams does lead the industry, there are plenty of competitors, most notably PPG Industries and Benjamin Moore. Other competitors include Behr and Axalta Coating Systems. There are also many trends currently dictating the industry. Due to environmental regulations, including VOC limits and emission controls, the research and development teams at these paint manufacturers are being pushed to pursue low-VOC, water borne, and more environmentally friendly paints. Also, companies are investing in technologies for color matching, pigment optimization, and AR/VR visualization.



Competitive Analysis (Porter's 5 Forces)

1) Threat of New Entrants: Low

- The paint and coatings industry requires a significant amount of capital to establish manufacturing facilities, distribution networks, and retail outlets. SHW runs 130 manufacturing and distribution facilities with over 5,000 retail stores in the United States.

2) Bargaining Power of Buyers: Moderate

- Has a diverse customer base
 - DIY painters, Professional painters and contractors, Retailers (Home Depot, Lowes, etc.)
- Buyers are relatively price inelastic in the paintings and coatings industry.

3) Bargaining Power of Supplier: Moderate

- The painting and coatings industry has a limited number of suppliers, giving them a larger power.
- Titanium dioxide and petrochemicals, key components that SHW is purchasing, have volatile prices
 - However, SHW is mitigating such power through longer term contracts
- General lack of differentiation in inputs

4) Threat of Substitutes: Moderate

- The Global Wall Coverings market is estimated to reach 37.5 billion in 2026
 - It is catching up, but it is not there with the paintings and coatings market
- The Global Power coatings market in 2024 is valued at 15.17 billion, and has a projection of 20.87 billion in 2030, with a rising CAGR of 5.46%
 - Although markets are rising, it is still nowhere close to the current paintings and coatings market

5) Degree of Rivalry: High

- Many competitors in the painting industry (primarily from Asia)
- Low-Moderate product differentiation
- SHW has a very big brand name, known for its reliability due to its long company longevity



Investment Thesis (Reasoning for each component of thesis follows it)

BUY

Thesis: We believe Sherwin-Williams (SHW) is a **buy** due to its growth through expansion, its lowering price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio through acquisition and share buybacks, and the company's wide moat compared to its competition.

The market views Sherwin-Williams as a company that will underperform in the future due to the absence of growth, a high price-to-earnings (P/E) ratio compared to expected earnings growth, and high competition with better growth expectations. However, each of these factors is viewed differently and incorrectly.

Catalyst 1: Growth for Sherwin-Williams has been flat for the past two years, which has been concerning some investors because the company has not been able to generate organic revenue growth. Sherwin-Williams decided to expand its revenue growth potential by completing the acquisition of BASF's Brazilian Architectural Paints Business(Suvinil) on October 1, 2025. This acquisition, for Sherwin-Williams, fits their long-term strategy of accelerating growth, global expansion, and increasing consumer solutions with new technology, distribution, and manufacturing.

Catalyst 2: Many analysts and investors worry about Sherwin-Williams trading at around a 33x price-earnings ratio, which is greater than the value that their competitors are trading at, which is an average of 18x, which many investors think is expensive for its revenue expectations. However, Sherwin-Williams has a pretty healthy profit margin and is expected to stabilize its P/E by increasing earnings with recent acquisitions and consistent share buybacks, which, with dividends, can return over \$716 million to shareholders.

Catalyst 3: Investors are mistaken to believe that Sherwin-Williams has a narrow moat and a lot of competition. Sherwin-Williams is different from other companies in terms of operations. Sherwin-Williams is the only paint manufacturer to own its full end-to-end supply chain, which drastically separates it from competitors in the market. As the company has a massive market share in the U.S. architectural paint industry of around 70%, the path for competitors to reach the scale of Sherwin-Williams is quite difficult.



Risk & Mitigants

Risk: One of the main risks for SHW is volatility in raw material prices, especially titanium dioxide and petrochemicals, which could put pressure on margins and near-term earnings stability.

Mitigant: Because SHW owns its full supply chain and operates at a massive scale, it can control costs better than competitors and pass through price increases to customers, protecting profitability and supporting consistent earnings, which is key for sustaining its P/E multiple.

Risk: Another key risk is the integration of BASF's Brazilian Architectural Paints Business (Suvnil). Large international acquisitions can face challenges, from cultural differences to operational complexity.

Mitigant: Still, Sherwin-Williams has a strong track record with past integrations like Valspar, and the company's disciplined management and regional expertise in Latin America give confidence that they'll execute successfully and capture synergies.

Risk: Lastly, the volatility in the housing and construction industry, as Sherwin-Williams is susceptible to economic slowdowns, and more specifically, the housing market. A clear example includes how the company cut its full-year profit forecast due to a downturn in the U.S. housing market.

Mitigant: The company's strong recurring revenue base from professional painters, who represent roughly 57% of total sales through the Paint Stores Group, along with its growing presence in industrial and international coatings, helps offset this exposure and provides more stable earnings through economic cycles.



SHW Financials

Income Statement

Breakdown	Historical				Projected				
	2021A	2022A	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Total Revenue	19,944.6	22,148.9	23,051.9	23,098.5	23,676.0	24,741.4	25,731.0	26,760.3	27,696.9
Cost of Operations	11,401.9	12,823.8	12,293.8	11,903.4	12,413.8	12,861.2	13,433.5	13,940.8	14,444.3
Gross Profit	8,542.7	9,325.1	10,758.1	11,195.1	11,262.2	11,880.2	12,297.5	12,819.5	13,252.6
Margin	42.83%	42.10%	46.67%	48.47%	47.57%	48.02%	47.79%	47.90%	47.85%
Depreciation & Amortization	572.6	581.1	624.0	622.5	658.9	649.1	706.3	711.6	760.3
Operating Expense	5,878.0	6,324.5	7,151.7	7,433.2	7,433.2	7,433.2	7,433.2	7,433.2	7,433.2
Selling General and Administrative	5,882.0	6,331.6	7,071.0	7,434.5	7,301.4	7,072.7	7,914.0	8,131.5	8,518.6
Research and Development	115.9	119.3	196.6	217.3	180.2	133.3	207.6	197.9	223.5
EBIT	2,583.3	2,963.9	3,527.4	3,867.5	3,829.0	4,447.0	4,978.0	5,410.9	5,845.0
Margin	12.95%	13.38%	15.30%	16.74%	16.17%	17.97%	19.35%	20.22%	21.10%
Interest Income	4.9	8.0	25.2	11.0	11.0	11.0	11.0	11.0	11.0
Interest Expense	334.7	390.8	417.5	415.7	411.7	436.5	456.7	476.9	491.6
Net Interest Income	(340.1)	(395.0)	(407.3)	(420.4)	(420.4)	(420.4)	(420.4)	(420.4)	(420.4)
Other Income Expense	(76.0)	(32.5)	(89.2)	110.3	43.6	43.6	43.6	43.6	43.6
Other Operating Expenses	(4.0)	(7.1)	80.7	(13.0)	12.7	12.7	12.7	12.7	12.7
EBT	2,248.6	2,573.1	3,109.9	3,451.8	3,417.3	4,010.5	4,521.3	4,934.0	5,353.4
Tax Provision	384.2	553.0	721.1	770.4	717.6	842.2	949.5	1036.1	1124.2
Net Income	1,864.4	2,020.1	2,388.8	2,681.4	2,699.7	3,168.3	3,571.8	3,897.9	4,229.2
Attributable to Non-Controlling Interest	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net Income Attributable to Sherwin-Williams	1,864.4	2,020.1	2,388.8	2,681.4	2,699.7	3,168.3	3,571.8	3,897.9	4,229.2
Margin	9.35%	9.12%	10.36%	11.61%	11.40%	12.81%	13.88%	14.57%	15.27%
Depreciation & Amortization	572.6	581.1	624.0	622.5	658.9	649.1	707.7	713.0	761.7
EBITDA	3,155.9	3,545.0	4,149.9	4,491.5	4,487.9	5,096.1	5,684.3	6,122.5	6,605.3
Margin	15.82%	16.01%	18.00%	19.44%	18.96%	20.60%	22.09%	22.88%	23.85%
Earnings Per Share									
Basic	7.10	7.83	9.35	10.68	10.46	12.28	13.84	15.11	16.39
Diluted	6.98	7.72	9.25	10.55	10.31	12.10	13.64	14.89	16.15
Shares Outstanding									
Basic	262.5	251.0	255.4	258.0	258.0	258.0	258.0	258.0	258.0
Diluted	267.1	254.1	258.3	261.8	261.8	261.8	261.8	261.8	261.8
Forecast									
Cost of Operations	57.17%	57.90%	53.33%	51.53%	52.43%	51.98%	52.21%	52.10%	52.15%
Depreciation, Amortization and Depletion	2.87%	2.62%	2.71%	2.69%	2.78%	2.62%	2.74%	2.66%	2.74%
Selling, General, and Administrative	29.49%	28.59%	30.67%	32.19%	30.84%	28.59%	30.76%	30.39%	30.76%
Research and Development	0.58%	0.54%	0.85%	0.94%	0.76%	0.54%	0.81%	0.74%	0.81%
Interest Expense	1.68%	1.76%	1.81%	1.80%	1.74%	1.76%	1.78%	1.78%	1.78%
Taxes	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%	21.00%

Revenue Build

Revenue Build (\$ in millions)	Historical				Projected				
	2021A	2022A	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Revenue	\$19,994.6	\$22,148.9	\$23,051.9	\$23,098.5	\$23,676.0	\$24,741.4	\$25,731.0	\$26,760.3	\$27,696.9
Paint Stores Group	10,616.2	11,963.3	12,839.5	13,188.0	13,583.6	14,127.0	14,621.4	15,060.1	15,436.6
Consumer Brands Group	3,322.4	3,388.4	3,365.6	3,108.0	3,170.2	3,178.1	3,225.8	3,290.3	3,356.1
Performance Coating Group	6,003.8	6,793.5	6,843.1	6,797.3	6,933.2	7,141.2	7,391.2	7,686.8	7,994.3
Administrative	2.2	3.7	3.7	5.2	5.5	5.6	5.8	5.9	6.0
Forecast									
Revenue	-	10.8%	4.1%	0.2%	2.5%	4.5%	4.0%	4.0%	3.5%
Paint Stores Group	-	12.7%	7.3%	2.7%	3.0%	4.0%	3.5%	3.0%	2.5%
Consumer Brands Group	-	2.0%	(0.7)%	(7.7)%	(2.0)%	0.25%	1.5%	2.0%	2.0%
Performance Coating Group	-	13.2%	0.7%	(0.7)%	2.0%	3.0%	3.50%	4.00%	4.0%
Administrative	-	68.2%	0.0%	40.5%	5.0%	3.0%	2.5%	2.0%	2.0%



Forecast Explanations: Since Sherwin-Williams is an established, steadily growing company, we expect the revenue to also steadily grow for the next couple of years. We believe that the revenue for the paint stores group (PSG) will steadily increase about 3-4% for the next few years. It is looking to build off of a strong Q3 2025 in which sales were up 3.6%. Additionally they also opened up 79 new PSG stores in 2024, which should contribute to some revenue increase. Additionally, SHW announced a 7% increase in all PSG products starting January 1st, 2026, which should increase some revenue. Although the last couple of years have not been very successful for the Consumer Brands Group (CBG) due to the lowering demand of DIY products, we believe that the company's recent \$1.15 billion acquisition of BASF Suvinil. We believe the added revenue gained from this company along with its presence in the Latin American market will slowly result in positive growth (about 1-2%) in CBG in the next couple of years. We also believe that the Performance Coatings Group (PCG) will also continue to grow due to the continual modest gains in the sale of automotive, industrial, and aerospace coatings. Lastly, the administrative group is a negligible revenue stream for the company and we project that its annual revenue will continue to hover around \$5-6 million dollars each year. When examining all four streams of revenue, we therefore project that the company will rebound from its relatively flat 2024 and slowly grow with a 2.5-4% annual growth rate.

Comparisons

As of (10-2-2025)		Market Cap	EV	LTM			
Company	Ticker	(\$MM)	EV (\$MM)	EV/EBITDA	EV/Revenue	P/E	
PPG Industries	NYSE: PPG	23.59	29.91	11.99x	1.91x	18.90x	Yahoo! Finance
RPM International	NYSE: RPM	14.91	17.62	16.01x	2.34x	21.73x	Yahoo! Finance
Masco Corporation	NYSE: MAS	14.86	17.70	14.28x	2.31x	18.83x	Yahoo! Finance
Axalta Coating Systems	NYSE: AXTA	6.11	8.90	8.63x	1.71x	13.82x	Yahoo! Finance
Sherwin-Williams	NYSE: SHW	84.65	97.99	22.27x	4.21x	33.20x	Yahoo! Finance
			Average	13.88x	2.07x	21.33x	
			Median	13.13x	2.11x	18.32x	
			Max	14.28x	2.34x	21.73x	
			Min	8.63x	1.91x	13.82x	

Valuations

EV/EBITDA Valuation Summary		EV/Revenue Valuation Summary		P/E Valuation Summary	
EBITDA	4,491.5	Revenue	23,098.50	EPS	10.68
Multiple	13.13x	Multiple	2.11x	Multiple	33.20x
Total Enterprise Value	58950.94	Total Enterprise Value	53,357.5	Total Enterprise Value	100,949.24
(-) Debt	9,888.40	(-) Debt	9,888.40	(-) Debt	9,888.40
(+) Cash	210.4	(+) Cash	210.4	(+) Cash	210.4
Total Equity Value	49272.94	Total Equity Value	43,679.5	Total Equity Value	91,481.64
Shares Outstanding	258.0	Shares Outstanding	258.0	Shares Outstanding	258.0
Implied Share Price	190.9804	Implied Share Price	128.41	Implied Share Price	354.58
Current Price (As of 11/9/25)	340.16	Current Price (As of 11/9/25)	340.16	Current Price (As of 11/9/25)	340.16
Upside (Downside)	(43.86)%	Upside (Downside)	(62.25)%	Upside (Downside)	4.24%



Balance Sheet

Balance Sheet (\$ In millions)	2020A	2021A	Historical 2022A	2023A	2024A
Assets:					
Current Assets:					
Cash and cash equivalents	226.6	165.7	198.8	276.8	210.4
Accounts receivable, less allowance	2,078.1	2,352.4	2,563.6	2,467.9	2,388.8
Inventories	1,804.1	1,927.2	2,626.5	2,329.8	2,288.1
Other current assets	482.6	608.4	518.8	438.4	513.5
Total current assets	4,591.4	5,053.7	5,907.7	5,512.9	5,400.8
Property, plant and equipment, net	1,834.5	1,867.3	2,207.0	2,836.8	3,533.2
Goodwill	7,049.1	7,134.6	7,583.2	7,626.0	7,580.1
Intangible assets, net	4,471.2	4,001.5	4,002.0	3,880.5	3,533.2
Operating lease right-of-use assets	1,761.1	1,820.6	1,866.8	1,887.4	1,953.8
Other assets	694.3	789.0	1,027.3	1,210.8	1,631.5
Total Assets	20,401.6	20,666.7	22,594.0	22,954.4	23,632.6
Liabilities and Shareholders' Equity:					
Current liabilities:					
Short-term borrowings	0.1	763.5	978.1	374.2	662.4
Accounts payable	2,117.8	2,403.0	2,436.5	2,315.0	2,253.2
Compensation and taxes withheld	752.7	716.6	784.5	862.7	842.8
Accrued taxes	183.5	160.3	197.4	197.4	174.3
Current portion of long-term debt	25.1	260.6	0.6	1,098.8	1,049.2
Current portion of operating lease liabilities	387.3	409.7	425.3	449.3	466.6
Other accruals	1,127.9	1,005.8	1,138.3	1,329.5	1,360.2
Total current liabilities	4,594.4	5,719.5	5,960.7	6,626.9	6,808.7
Long-term debt	8,266.9	8,590.9	9,591.0	8,377.9	8,176.8
Postretirement benefits other than pensions	275.6	259.4	139.3	133.2	120.7
Deferred income taxes	846.1	768.2	681.6	683.1	607.5
Long-term operating lease liabilities	1,434.1	1,470.7	1,512.9	1,509.5	1,558.3
Other long-term liabilities	1,373.7	1,420.8	1,606.4	1,908.0	2,309.4
Shareholders' equity:					
Common Stock	89.9	90.8	91.2	91.8	92.5
Other capital	3,491.4	3,793.0	3,963.9	4,193.6	4,576.2
Retained earnings	844.3	2,121.7	3,523.2	5,288.3	7,246.3
Treasury stock, at cost	(96.5)	(2,869.9)	(3,775.6)	(5,233.6)	(6,988.6)
Accumulated other comprehensive loss	(718.3)	(698.4)	(700.6)	(624.3)	(875.2)
Total shareholders' equity	3,610.8	2,437.2	3,102.1	3,715.8	4,051.2
Total Liabilities and Shareholders' Equity	20,401.6	20,666.7	22,594.0	22,954.4	23,632.6



Cash Flow Statement

Cash Flow Statements (\$ In millions)	2021A	2022A	Historical 2023A	2024A
Cash provided by operating activities:				
Net income	\$1,864.40	\$2,020.10	\$2,388.80	\$2,681.40
Adjustments to reconcile net income to cash provided by operating actives:				
Depreciation, amortization, depletion and accretion	263.1	264	292.3	297.4
Non-cash interest expense	334.7	390.8	417.5	415.7
Stock-based compensation	97.7	99.7	115.9	138.1
Deferred tax provision (benefit)	80.3	144.8	88.9	74.9
Provision for doubtful accounts	33.8	65.3	67.9	69.5
Loss on extinguishment of debt	1.4	0.0	12.8	0.0
(Gain) loss on disposition of assets & impairments, net	6.1	10.7	0.9	49.9
Environmental adjustments	7.1	80.7	1.3	1.3
Other non-cash items	43.9	6.8	7	6.1
Change in assets and liabilities				
Accounts receivable	200.2	10.7	85.6	10.7
Prepaid expenses and other assets	32.5	31.5	31.5	31.5
Accounts payable	46.6	21.8	241.1	21.8
Other tabites	43.9	6.8	7	6.1
Cash provided by operating activities:	3,055.70	3,153.70	3,759.50	3,804.40
Purchases of property and equipment	372	644.5	888.4	1,070
Proceeds from sales of property and equipment	14.8	33.2	70.1	11.6
Cash used in acquisitions and investments	210.9	1003.1	264.7	78.9
Cash received from business divestitures	122.5	0.0	103.7	0.0
Other (investing)	6.8	59	60	59
Cash used in investing activities:	(438.80)	1,673.40	1,673.40	(1,196.30)
Proceeds from credit facilities & notes payable	763.9	214.4	603.9	288.6
Proceeds from issuance of senior notes	999.7	0.0	0.0	848.7
Payments of credit facilities & notes payable	11.5	7.3	0.0	8.6
Issuances of common stock, net	90	30	30	30
Purchases of common stock for treasury	10.1	3.4	5.6	5.2
Cash dividends	587.1	618.5	623.7	723.4
Cash provided by (used in) financing activities:	1,244.90	(384.80)	4.6	430.10
Effect of foreign-exchange rate changes on cash	9.8	28.8	14.1	12.2
Increase (decrease) in cash:	60.9	33.1	78.0	66.4
Cash at the beginning of the year	226.6	165.7	198.8	276.8
Cash at the end of the year	165.7	198.8	276.8	210.4



Sources

2024 Annual Report & 10-K: Sherwin-Williams reported record net sales of \$23.10 billion and diluted net income per share of \$10.55 for FY 2024. [Q4 Investor Relations](#)

P/E Ratio: As of October 17, 2025, Sherwin-Williams had a trailing P/E ratio of 30.00. [Macrotrends](#)

Forward P/E: The forward P/E ratio is approximately 26.67. [Yahoo! Finance](#)

MarketWatch: Average price target of \$382.84, with a high of \$420.00 and a low of \$335.00. [MarketWatch](#)

TipRanks: Average price target of \$388.43, indicating a 17.44% potential upside from the current price of \$330.74. [TipRanks](#)

StockAnalysis: Average price target of \$384.07, forecasting a 16.12% increase over the next year. [Zacks](#)

Heidi G. Petz: Chair, President, and Chief Executive Officer. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Allen J. Mistysyn: Senior Vice President - Finance and Chief Financial Officer. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Justin T. Binns: President, Global Architectural. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Marlena K. Boyce: Senior Vice President, Human Resources. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Colin M. Davie: President & General Manager, Global Supply Chain Division, Consumer Brands Group. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Mary L. Garceau: Senior Vice President - Chief Legal Officer and Secretary. [Sherwin-Williams Investor Relations](#)

Analyst Consensus: The consensus rating for Sherwin-Williams is "Moderate Buy," based on 12 buy ratings and 5 hold ratings. [TipRanks](#)

Recent Financial Outlook: In July 2025, Sherwin-Williams revised its full-year adjusted profit forecast to a range of \$11.20 to \$11.50 per share, down from the earlier projection of \$11.65 to \$12.05, due to weaker-than-expected demand. [Reuters](#)

Market Performance: As of October 17, 2025, Sherwin-Williams' stock price is \$330.74, with a 52-week range of \$310.00 to \$420.00. [Yahoo! Finance](#)

The Sherwin-Williams Company. The Sherwin-Williams Company Reports 2024 Year-End and Fourth Quarter Financial Results: [\[Press Release, 2025\]](#)

The Sherwin-Williams Company. Sherwin-Williams Completes Acquisition of BASF's Brazilian Architectural Paints Business: [\[Press Release, 2025\]](#)

AlphaSpread. Sherwin-Williams Co. (SHW): [Revenue Breakdown.](#)



Titanium Dioxide Volatile Material Prices: [Yahoo! Finance](#)

SHW Porter's 5 Forces: [DCF Modeling](#)

Wall Coverings Industry: [Yahoo! Finance](#)

Global Powder Coatings Industry: [Yahoo! Finance](#)

SHW Market Dominance: [Jensen Investments](#)

Q4 Sales:

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More SHW Sales:

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